follow you in success, but if they will stick by you in defeat and hardship.'[3] *Therefore, we need the best officers to lead the units and formations and give the kind of leadership our warriors deserve. They must be thorough professionals with adequate experience, particularly in command of troops.*

We must inculcate an offensive spirit and a proactive approach in our subordinates. As no plan survives the first engagement, we must train ourselves and our commands to be dynamic and flexible and practise the directive style of leadership. Remember to be two steps ahead of the adversary. We must seize fleeting opportunities and take bold actions and calculated risks, but no gambles – lives are at stake! Surprise, deception and an element of cunningness should be ingrained into our thought process and plans. Our men are naive by nature and the average officer is too conventional. We must change the predictability in our approach and begin to do the unexpected. In fact, an unconventional plan could be the battle-winning factor. You will probably get your objective faster and certainly with lesser number of bodybags. Always be original and innovative and don't do the 'bhed chaal' (the way the sheep follow each other). In war as in peace, try to be the top dog – always in command of the situation. I have always been a practitioner of 'Chanakyaniti' (the principles of Chanakya).

This brings me to the most crucial element in any war, past, present or future – the fighting man. The man behind the machine should be well-trained, physically and mentally robust, highly motivated and imbued with great esprit de corps. I have often stated that our men should have their 'batteries' fully charged and be raring to go into action. Therefore it is imperative that we as leaders should see to it that our men have time for rest and recreation. A tired army shall never deliver. We must never forget that the soldier is the ultimate determinant of victory in the battlefield. The well-being of the soldier's family and dependents is a dimension that is also extremely important. Our welfare schemes ought to assure the soldier that his family would be looked after should anything happen to him.

To evolve into an army of the twenty-first century, it is axiomatic that our 'mantra' should be modernization. I highlighted the need for acquisition of arms and equipment to replace some of our obsolete inventory, which had reached unacceptable levels. Therefore, I would like to see the results of the impetus given by the government for the modernization of the army and the induction of high-end technology and improvement of our night-fighting capabilities. This, along with information technology, information warfare and netcentric warfare, would be the essence of modernization during my tenure. India is known for its progress in the field of information technology all over the world